What Makes an Online Course Popular?

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To what extent do course duration, final price, and discount percentage influence student enrollment on the Shaguf platform?

INTRODUCTION

Why This Matters?

The world of online learning is booming, especially in the Arab region. But what actually makes a student click "Enroll"? We analyzed **Shaguf**, a Saudi-based platform, to see if local students behave differently than those on global giants like Udemy and Coursera. Our goal was to find the "sweet spot" between affordable education and high-quality teaching.

OBJECTIVES

Our Big Questions

- Does a longer course mean more students?
- Do massive discounts actually work, or do they look "cheap"?
- What matters more: the price tag or the person teaching?

DATA COLLECTION

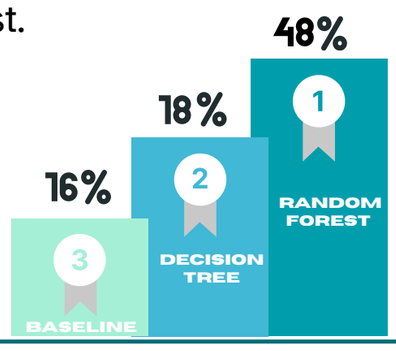
- **Shaguf:** We "scraped" data from ~1,000 courses to see what's happening in the local market.
- **Global Giants:** We compared this to over ~4,500 courses from Udemy and Coursera.
- **What we looked at:** Prices, course hours, student numbers, and instructor popularity.

MODELS AND FINDINGS

We tested three different AI "brains" to see which could best predict if a course would be a hit.

The Winner: Random Forest model

- **The Secret Ingredient:** It turns out Instructor Reputation is the #1 factor. Students aren't just buying a course; they are buying into a teacher they trust.

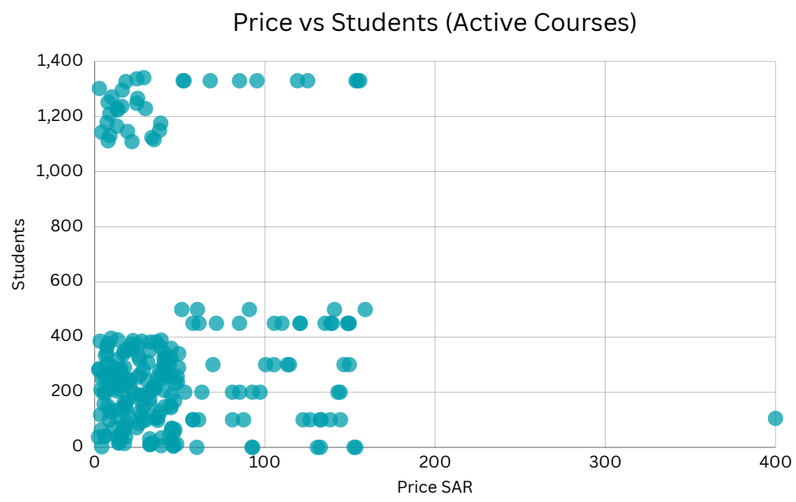


DATA ANALYSIS

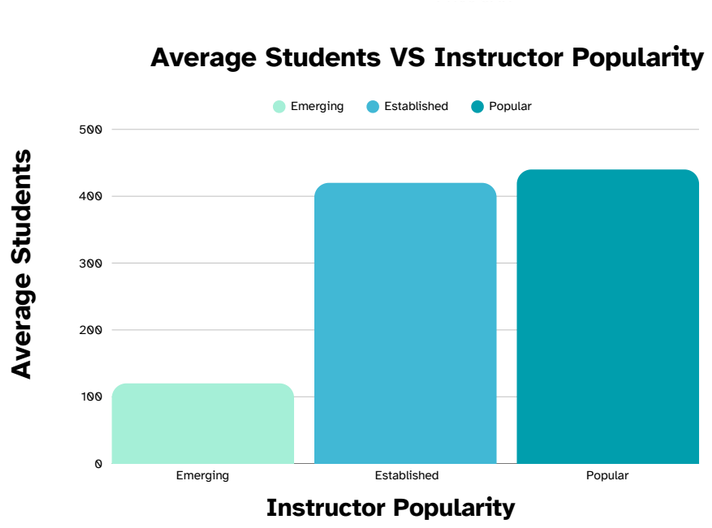
What the Data Told Us?



- **The "Discount" Trap** Surprisingly, massive 90% discounts don't always bring in more students. People often trust courses with modest or no discounts more



- **Price Distribution**: On Shaguf, 80% of active courses are under 30 SAR. It's a highly accessible, student-friendly market



- **The Reputation Gap**: Established and popular instructors attract approximately **3.5 times more students** than emerging instructors

CONCLUSION

1. Trust Over Price: If you want a popular course, focus on your reputation as a teacher.

2. Be Concise: Don't pad your course with extra hours, students value their time.

3. Local Pride: There is a huge demand for specialized, high-level academic content in the Arabic market that global platforms aren't filling.

